FEDERAL STANDARD

TELECOMMUNICATIONS: CHARACTER STRUCTURE AND CHARACTER PARITY SENSE FOR SERIAL-BY-BIT DATA COMMUNICATION IN THE AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARD CODE FOR INFORMATION INTERCHANGE

This standard is issued by the General Services Administration pursuant to the Federal Property and Administrative Services Act of 1949, as amended, and Public Law 89-306. This standard has also been published as an integral part of Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) Publication 17-1. The application of this standard to data processing systems and telecommuncation systems is mandatory on all Federal agencies.

1. Scope. This standard specifies the character structure and character parity sense for serial by bit data communication using the American National Standard Code for Information Interchange (ASCII).

1.1 Purpose. Federal telecommunication standards are to facilitate interoperability between telecommunication facilities and systems and compatibility of these systems at the computer-communications interface with data processing equipment.

1.2 Application. This standard shall be used by Federal agencies with other Federal Standards or design specifications describing functional, mechanical and procedural characteristics as necessary to achieve interoperability. Systems in existence on the date of this standard which are designed to a different character parity sense specification are not required to comply with the parity sense requirement in this standard.

2. Reference document. This standard adopts the following American National Standards Institute (ANSI) document to the extent specified herein:

X3.16-1976 Character Structure and Character Parity Sense for Parallel-by-Bit Data Communication in the American National Standard Code for Information Interchange.

Copies may be obtained from ANSI, Inc., 1430 Broadway, New York, New York 10018. Federal Agencies may obtain copies with FIPS Publication 17-1 from the National Technical Information Service, Document Processing Branch, 5285 Port Royal Road, Springfield, VA 22161.

3. Changes. When a Federal agency considers that this standard does not provide for its essential needs, a statement citing inadequacies shall be sent in duplicate to the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, FMH, Washington, DC 20406, in accordance with provisions of Federal Property Management Regulations 41 CFR 101-29.3. The General Services Administration will determine the appropriate action to be taken and will notify the agency.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

National Communications System (NCS)
Office of Technology and Standards
Washington, D.C. 20305

Records of coordination with affected Federal Agencies are maintained by the preparing activity.

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